

Note that the code samples and screen shots in this chapter assume that you're using Flash Builder 4.5 to build the application. If you're using the Flex 4.5 SDK and your own text editor, the steps will be similar, but you won't have access to some of the code completion and other productivity tools described.

Hello World

In all programming languages, your first task is to write a “Hello World” application. The simplest of applications, it typically contains no more than a single line of text output.

Throughout these instructions, we will assume that you're using the stand-alone version of Flash Builder. Where the steps are different in the plug-in version, we provide alternative steps. Your first step is to create a Flex project. The project hosts the application's source code and other assets.

Follow these steps to switch to a new workspace:

1. Open Flash Builder 4.5
2. From the menu, choose File and then click Switch Workspace.
3. Select a new folder named `flexprogram` anywhere on your hard disk and then click OK. If you're working on Windows, the folder might be `C:\flexprogram`. On Mac OS X, the folder should be in your home directory; for example, `/Users/[username]/Documents/flexprogram`.

After selecting the workspace, you should see Flash Builder close and reopen. The new workspace should display the Flash Builder Start Page and the default Flash perspective. The newly created workspace is empty and contains no projects. Workspace folders are sometimes created as sibling folders to the projects they reference, rather than parent folders. This is because a workspace contains references to an absolute location on the hard disk and isn't portable. If you change the location of your project folders, you have to re-create the workspace.

You can re-create a workspace from scratch by first closing Flash Builder and then deleting the workspace folder's `.metadata` subfolder using Windows Explorer or Finder. When you reopen Flash Builder, the workspace data is recreated automatically. You'll then need to import any existing projects to see them in the Package Explorer view. Choose File > Import to open the Import dialog box. Then choose General > Existing Projects into Workspace. Browse and select the project's root folder. After verifying that your project is visible and has been selected, click Finish.